

ETHYL CYANOACRYLATE

_____Name

_____Date

also called...various brand names like Super Glue, Permabond, and Krazy Glue.

What is it?

Cyanoacrylate is instant glue.

Where might it be found?

Nail cosmetic uses:

- Nail glue
- Mend broken nails
- Add preformed plastic nails
- Adhere nail tips
- Nail sculpture kits
- Adhere silk nail wrap
- Adhere linen to broken nail

Hairdresser uses:

- Attach hair

Surgical uses:

- Close wounds*
- Fasten tissues together
- Seal skin cracks
- Wound spray dressing
- Repair vertebral discs*
- Prevent ileostomy appliance leakage*

Household or workplace adhesive:

- Glue shoes
- Glue plastics
- Glue metal, rubber, glass
- Glue textiles
- Circuit boards
- Aircraft industry
- Automobile industry
- Film former

*this may use a different but related cyanoacrylate

Allergy to cyanoacrylate usually produces redness, tenderness, and swelling at the site of use and nearby. When used on the nails, the cuticle and the skin folds alongside the nails become inflamed. Often this causes the nail to have grooves and wrinkles, rather than be smooth. Sometimes the nail is shed.

Ethyl cyanoacrylate can cause problems in nail technicians from contact during their work. The glue may also produce reactions far away from the area directly touching the glue. Face, eyes, and airway may become irritated by vapors. Glue allergens transferred by the hands can produce eyelid dermatitis, and less commonly a widespread rash of small scaling patches. Increasing the humidity in the air where the cyanoacrylate is used may reduce these problems.

How to avoid it:

Do not use cyanoacrylate glues. Nylon, rubber, and vinyl gloves do not provide protection. Polyethylene or polypropylene gloves are helpful. For several hours' protection, wear Silver Shield/4H plastic polymer gloves (www.allerderm.com, 800-365-6868 or www.northsafety.com, 800-430-4110), Barrier Chemical Resistant Gloves (www.ansellpro.com, 800-800-0444), or polyvinyl alcohol gloves (www.grainger.com or www.airgas.com).

Tell your manicurist about your allergy.